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October 14, 2026

Dear Editors,

On behalf of the author team, I am pleased to submit our paper, "Strategically mitigating the impacts of offshore wind on marine fisheries can also promote climate resilience", for consideration as a Full Length Article in *Marine Policy*.

The rapid expansion of offshore wind (OSW) is key to achieving global climate goals but is expected to negatively impact marine fisheries. While tools for avoiding and minimizing these conflicts through marine spatial planning are well-established, less guidance exists on mitigating the unavoided impacts, especially using strategies beyond direct financial compensation.

We developed a menu of strategies for mitigating the socioeconomic impacts of OSW on fisheries through a telescoping review procedure that narrowly begins with a California (U.S.) case study and methodically widens the field of view to examine other U.S. offshore wind farms and mitigation guidance. We extracted distinct mitigation "measures" from each source then grouped them into broader mitigation "strategies." Finally, we identified the attributes of climate resilience (Mason et al., 2022) supported by each strategy. This (1) reveals the preferences and shortcomings of each source of mitigation measures regarding measures that support resilience and (2) allows designers of future fisheries mitigation plans to consider mitigation strategies that support each realm of climate resilience.

Our review identified 60 mitigation measures within 25 broader mitigation strategies. The identified strategies extended beyond direct financial compensation to include investments in port infrastructure, seafood marketing, workforce development, fisheries science, governance participation, vessel safety, and other initiatives. These strategies offer strong support for socioeconomic resilience (5 of 5 resilience domains; 12 of 15 resilience attributes) and moderate support for resilience in governance (2 of 4 domains; 6 of 10 attributes) but offer weak support for ecological resilience (1 of 3 domains; 4 of 13attributes). Most of the identified strategies could be financed, implemented, and enforced through community benefit agreements (contractual agreements between OSW project developers and impacted communities) in close partnership with local business, regulatory, educational, and research institutions. Although all of the identified mitigation strategies represent fisheries subsidies, many of which are capacity-enhancing, most are not harmful as long as governance is strong.

We envision that this menu of mitigation strategies could be used to strategically design mitigation plans that diversify their support for long-term resilience when offsetting the impacts of OSW development and other emerging ocean uses on marine fisheries.

Thank you for your consideration and we look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely, on behalf of all authors,
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